circumstantial evidence of Gulab Singh's role in the death of his brother Dhyan Singh, and him demoting Poonch's status down to being a *jagir*, angered the surviving clansmen of Dhyan Singh, who were led by Jawahir Singh and his younger brother, Moti Singh. They petitioned the British, who did not want to annoy Gulab Singh, their trusted ally. In 1852, the arbitrator, Sir Frederick Currie, the British Resident in Lahore ruled that Gulab Singh was indeed the *suzerain*, or the feudal overlord, of Poonch.[22] The *jagir* was further sub-divided into Jawahir Singh's 2/3 share and the remaining 1/3 share of Moti Singh. Later on, in 1859, Maharaja Ranbir Singh and the British levelled a charge of 'treacherous conspiracy' against Jawahir Singh and dispossessed him of his rightful 2/3 share. This left Moti Singh, his son Baldev Singh and grandson Jagat Dev Singh with a much-truncated *jagir*. The descendants of Raja Dhyan Singh had been marginalised by those of his brother Gulab Singh, and this inter-generational bitterness continued to the era of Hari Singh.

When a beleaguered Maharaja Pratap Singh sought to resist the combined pressure of Raja Amar Singh and his British masters to impose Hari Singh as the heir to the throne, he turned to his marginalised second cousin's nephew, Jagat Dev Singh, and adopted him as his son and heir. Jagat Dev Singh performed the last rites of Maharaja Pratap Singh in 1925 and became the Raja of Poonch in 1928. Hari Singh, however, continued the policy of marginalisation towards the *jagir* and imposed a *sanad*, or a land deed, on him, further implementing several encroachments on his administration. Further, a diarchy was established. Hari Singh appointed a Resident Administrator and more officials were loaned from the state, leaving Raja Jagat Dev Singh's jurisdiction to handle only petty cases. All serious crimes were referred to the courts in Srinagar. The Raja of Poonch's powers were completely diminished and the throne had lost its prestige as well as power.

With the British and the Maharaja both against the Raja of Poonch, and with the residual part of the state being inconsequential because of Maharaja's imposition of heavy taxes, the choices for Raja Jagat Dev Singh were very limited. It can be argued that with rising powers of the Muslim